

Vivian:

For this project, we worked together to build an interactive “cozy ecosystem” in p5.js, kind of inspired by the vibe of a game called Tiny Glade. Tasha mainly worked on the visuals and sound, including all the drawings and audio, while I focused more on the game functionality and interactions. The idea was to let players spawn creatures and plants (kind of alien-like creatures and plants) and then interact with them using tools like food, water, and a sword. We added behaviors like creatures hopping around, reacting to the player (running away or moving toward things), growing when fed, and eventually dying when killed with a sword. We also worked on the UI, like buttons and custom cursors, so it feels more like a small game instead of just a basic sketch.

The project changed a lot from what we first imagined. At the beginning, it was pretty simple, just blue circles hopping and green circles on the screen. As we kept adding features, it became more like an overall system. We had to reorganize and clean up our code multiple times, especially for handling input and interactions, because things got messy pretty quickly as we added more functionality.

We had a lot of freedom with this project which made it very fun to work on. If we had more time, we would definitely expand the interactions further, especially between the creatures and plants. Overall, it was a really fun project, and it was satisfying seeing everything come together visually and interactively!

Tasha:

For this project, we both agreed to work on a simple cozy game inspired by Tiny Glade (spawning things) and Stardew Valley (pixel art). I was responsible for the art and audio while Vivian focused on the mechanics. We wanted to keep it simple by creating buttons for spawning animals and plants, as well as feeding, watering, and killing options. We discussed how else to bring life into the game, including features such as making the creatures hop around and grow slightly whenever they are fed so it wouldn't be so static.

Our first main idea was, whenever we picked up the sword, the creatures would hop away from it, while whenever we picked up food, it would attract the creatures. We initially settled on farm animals, but then pivoted to drawing alien-like creatures. Since it was a whimsical game we wanted to deviate slightly from the norm, also reflected in the design of the plants and the environment. The background was layered so that the cloud and fog layers would move at different speeds, so that there was some passive movement in-game. However, one main problem we came across was script management since there were so many layers and sprites to organise.

Once we had the main mechanics working, we added smaller details like a roast turkey sprite once a creature is killed, or overwatering would kill plants, so that there was a reason for them

to despawn. We also looked for sound effects as microfeedback for almost every interaction, like button click, feeding, etc. If we had more time, we would have liked to add interactions between the creatures and plants, but overall I think we're pretty satisfied with the project. Seeing it come together as we worked on it was very fulfilling, and working with another person was fun and insightful.